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Market Briefs Pro

Read Less News

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Eighteen months ago, we reported on the significant strides being made in the space economy.

The report followed our investment thesis from last year: Iron-and-lumber.

What does that mean? What matters more isn't whether space innovation projects or technology takes off.

What matters is the infrastructure that makes these projects valuable.

The report focused on the actual, investable, infrastructure such as:

- Satellites.
- Lunar logistics.

This is the foundational layer that every future space economy needs to function.

The bottom line: *We were right* - and the way it played out taught us something we didn't fully anticipate.

Spending did increase from the government and investors in the space economy, which led to the opportunities we identified to grow.

But two things defined the space sector's evolution since our last report - and only one of them was on our radar.

The first was execution risk becoming the dominant pricing factor.

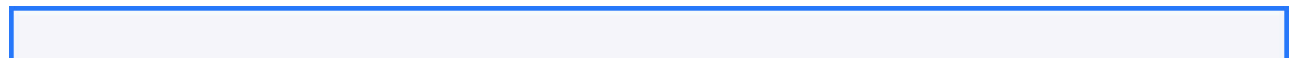
Investors in 2025 stopped giving space companies the benefit of the doubt they'd enjoyed for years.

Actually, delivery mattered more than a *promise* to deliver.

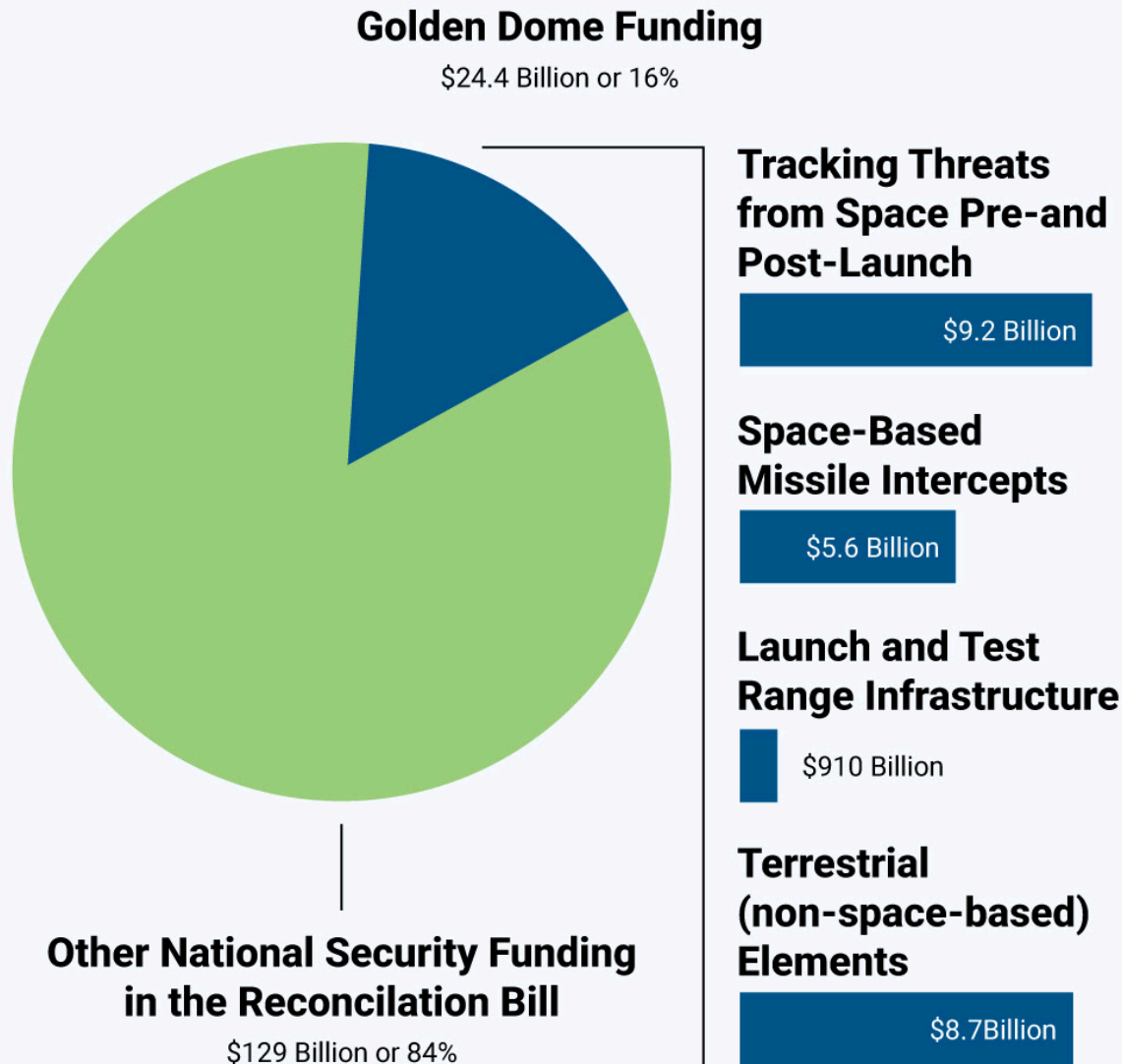
That played out almost exactly as we expected.

What we underestimated was the *gravitational pull* of national security spending.

Space Force's budget request for FY2026 came in at \$39.9 billion, up significantly from FY2025's \$28.8 billion, with \$13.8 billion of that figure tied specifically to the Golden Dome defense initiative.



Golden Dome Funding



Data [via](#) Center For Aerospace Strategy

Commercial exploration, which most analysts still view as the long-term engine of the space industry's growth, got overshadowed in the near term.

Here's what all of this means for investors: The companies with defense contracts aren't just doing well - they're doing measurably better than everyone else.

So this week, we're revisiting this Innovation Shift on the space economy - we'll show you what we're still backing, what we're holding and two new names we're identifying as opportunities.

ANALYST TAKE

Tickers we're tracking:

What we're keeping: LUNR, PL, RCLB

What we're holding on: ASTS, FLY

What we're adding: RWD, SPIR

WHAT WE'RE KEEPING

Three Companies We're Still Backing

Intuitive Machines (LUNR)

Going to the moon is one thing, but actually landing on it is a whole different story.

Intuitive Machines was an opportunity we spotted for its state-of-the-art landing tech.

But Intuitive Machines gave us a glimpse into what happens when a space stock does not deliver.

Intuitive Machines had back-to-back missions that didn't stick their landings, and the market responded exactly the way you'd expect.

Shares dropped - and for a few months, the thesis looked shaky.

But Intuitive Machines bounced back. Unlike many other names in the space race, Intuitive Machines has been around for over a decade.

So it's been here before and despite the operational setbacks, it added some serious business momentum.

The company brought Lanteris Space Systems into its portfolio, locked in a role supporting the Artemis II mission - NASA's first crewed lunar orbit in decades - and made

meaningful progress shrinking its losses.

Intuitive Machines, Inc. (LUNR)

6 Months Price → **\$18.37**
(103.95%)



 Briefs Terminal

Data [via](#) Briefs Terminal

- Over the last six months ending February 26th, 2026, shares of the company are up 98%.

The risk profile hasn't disappeared, but the direction of travel has clearly shifted.

For investors with patience and risk tolerance, this one still looks like a high-growth prospect, and one we're backing in the long-term.

Planet Labs (PL)

Here's something that has been growing in demand for years: Satellites.

From GPS, to defense, there are now around 15,000 satellites orbiting Earth right now.

Planet Labs owns 200 of those satellites and takes terabytes worth of images of our planet every day. (Terabyte = a very large amount of data).

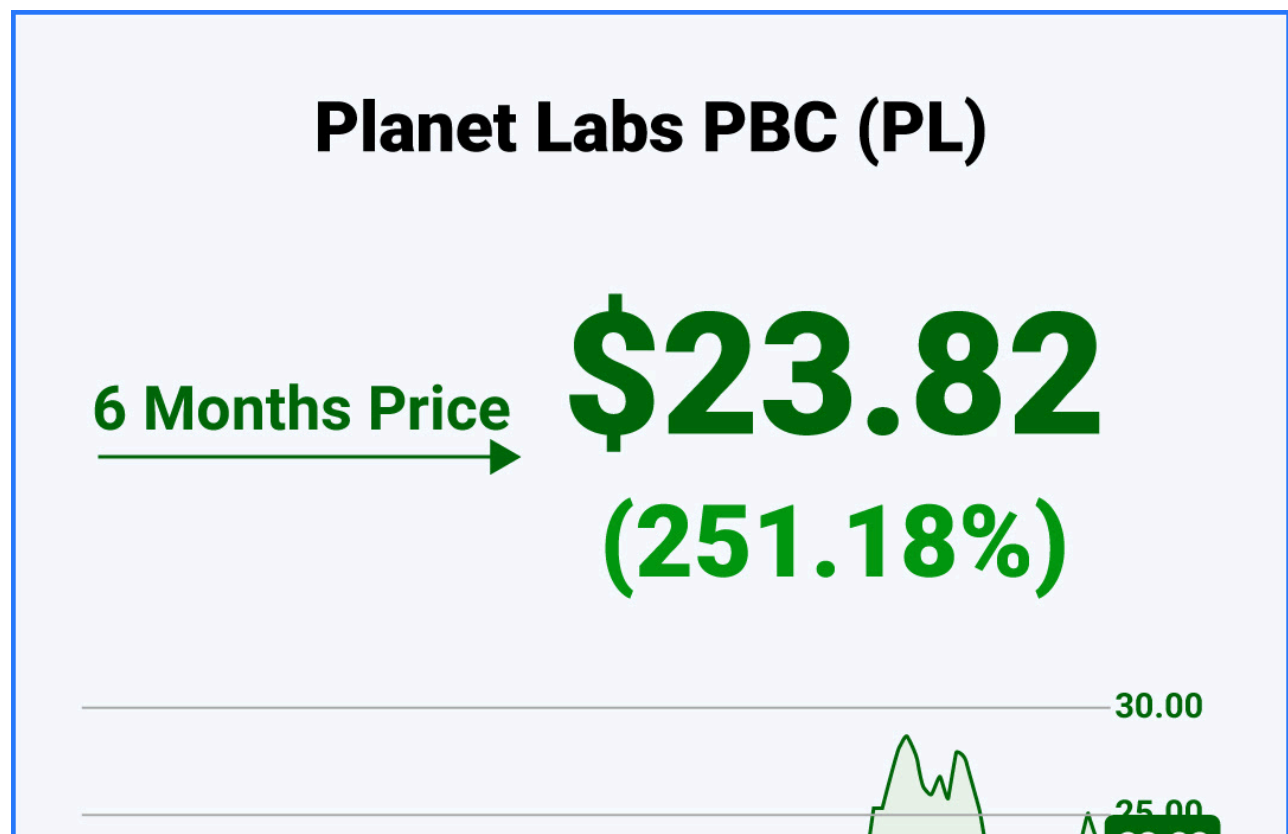
Eighteen months ago, Planet Labs had impressive technology, but shaky financials.

- The share price dropped to around \$2 in early 2024, from an all-time high of over \$11 set in November, 2021.

The company had one of the largest commercial satellite imaging networks in existence, but couldn't translate that into a business model the market believed in.

Then in 2025, it had a breakthrough.

Planet Labs inked some defense contracts, which improved margins.





Data [via](#) Briefs Terminal

And on December 10th, 2025, Planet Labs dropped a quarterly report that reframed the entire narrative: revenue up 33% year-over-year, beating expectations by 13%.

The order backlog grew by more than 200%, with Defense and Intelligence revenue jumping 70%.

Planet Labs also made more money overall in 2025, a positive pattern for investors.

As a result, shares have grown more than 266% over the last six months.

If its satellites continue to take off, this could be a potential long-term opportunity for investors.

Rocket Lab (RKLB)

Finally, we have Rocket Lab - a classic take on space companies.

Rocket Lab sends satellites and other pieces of critical infrastructure into space with rockets and is pioneering orbital launch tech.

In English: When you imagine what a space company does, you are probably thinking of Rocket Labs' core business: sending massive rockets into space.

In 2025, Rocket Lab:

- Added to its launch backlog, which now sits at 49 confirmed missions.
- Picked up a defense sensor company through an acquisition.
- Continued development on its next-generation Neutron rocket.

A testing incident late in the year led to a sell-off, though, a reminder that the market is watching every move.

Rocket Lab Corporation (RKLB)

6 Months Price → **\$70.21**
(58.20%)



Even still, the stock finished the last six months up almost 51%.

Why are we backing it? It aligns with our thesis - Rocket Lab has proven itself already, which allows it to stand out from a crowd of unproven space companies.

That consistency has value - which may give it an edge for some investors who are considering this potential opportunity.

WHAT WE'RE HOLDING ONTO

What We're Holding

AST SpaceMobile (ASTS)

Cell service right from space is at the core of [AST SpaceMobile's](#) business.

Over the last year or so, it's taken that idea from concept to commercial reality faster than most expected.

The company has locked up partnerships with more than 50 wireless carriers globally, including a high-profile agreement with Verizon that became a significant stock catalyst last fall.

Shares are up over 70% over the last six months, and the business is executing.

So, why are we still holding? *Scale and volatility.* AST has grown into a \$31 billion company, and at that size, the math on future returns changes.

AST SpaceMobile, Inc. (ASTS)

6 Months Price **\$83.94**



Data [via](#) Briefs Terminal

The stock also swings aggressively on news - in either direction.

For investors already in the position, the story remains intact.

- For new money entering now, the risk-to-reward ratio has gotten smaller compared to where it was a year ago.

We're not selling - but we'll need to see another breakthrough or earnings beat to justify the entry point right now.

Firefly Aerospace (FLY)

Firefly's IPO was one of the most anticipated of 2025.

The first earnings report after going public was also one of the most disappointing.

Revenue fell year-over-year, and the per-share loss came in more than ten times worse than what analysts had modeled.

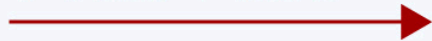
Shares lost nearly three-quarters of their value from the peak.

- The company recovered some ground by the third quarter, and it carries a contract backlog north of \$1.1 billion.

Again, this is real business, not just promises.

Firefly Aerospace Inc. (FLY)

1 Year Price



\$20.20
(-71.46%)



Data [via](#) Briefs Terminal

We're holding onto this one for two reasons.

For one, its technology is competitive - it creates reusable rockets, one of the only public companies doing this.

And two, post IPO companies can be tricky to analyze.

We don't have enough evidence yet that the share price has found stable footing.

Until that picture clarifies, we're watching rather than adding.

WHAT WE'RE ADDING

Two New Names on Our Radar

Redwire (RDW)

New opportunities have emerged in this shift over the past year and a half.

One of those is Redwire - which plays perfectly into our iron-and-lumber thesis.

While the rest of the sector competes for launch contracts and lunar landing rights, Redwire focuses on what goes inside the spacecraft - structural components, docking systems, and microgravity manufacturing equipment.

Large Space Infrastructure

Differentiators

- ROSA heritage on the ISS, DART, Maxar's Ovzon 3, and more
- Key supplier for ROSA and IBDM on funded contracts from customers
- Protected IP such as Roll-out design

Q3 2025 Proof Point

- Awarded a contract to develop and deliver ROSA wings for Axiom Station's Payload Power Thermal Module
- Redwire's ROSA technology has a 100% success rate of on-orbit performance across a wide range of civil and commercial missions

Future Growth

- Working with existing customers such as Blue Origin and Thales to scale future ROSA orders
- Targeting all commercial LEO destination providers with ROSA, IBDM and other infrastructure
- Position ROSA and IBDM for other power-intensive spacecraft programs and Moon-to-Mars infrastructure

 Market Briefs Pro

Data via Redwire's investor presentation

That critical infrastructure doesn't grab the headlines, but it does attract dollars, as many space missions can't happen without its help.

In 2025, the stock had a rough year, undergoing restructuring and a couple of earnings disappointments.

But it may have turned the corner in 2026.

Redwire secured participation in the SHIELD contract - part of the \$151 billion Golden Dome build-out - and added new commercial partnerships, including docking systems for The Exploration Company's Nyx spacecraft.

Microgravity Development

Differentiators

- 100s of microgravity experiments conducted
- Proven PIL-BOX IP
- Existing funded customers (commercial, government, and international)

Q3 2025 Proof Point

- Launched 14 PIL-BOXes to the ISS in Q3 bringing our total to 42 PIL-BOXes to-date, studying 35 unique molecules
- The 14 PIL-BOXes are studying 18 molecules with three different partners: Bristol Myers Squibb, Butler University, and Purdue University

Future Growth

- Pharma has a <10% success rate from Phase 1 to approval and a fast approaching patent cliff that threatens-\$350B in annual worldwide revenue from drugs losing exclusivity through 2030
- Targeting royalty partnerships with biotech companies for drug development and new therapies



Data [via](#) Redwire's investor presentation

Shares are up just over 5% YTD as of February 26th, 2026.

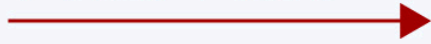
And while that may not sound like a lot, the [S&P 500](#) is up less than 1% in that same time frame.

The business also looks cleaner after its restructuring and may be headed towards a meaningful recovery.

In short - Redwire could be undervalued right now, which may create an opportunity for investors to grab shares before the broader market catches on.

Redwire Corporation (RDW)

1 Year Price



\$8.08
(-54.66%)



 Briefs Terminal

Data [via](#) Briefs Terminal

Spire Global (SPIR)

Spire Global is another opportunity we've spotted since we published our last report on space stocks.

Spire doesn't fit the typical space company mold, which is part of what makes it interesting.

The company runs a network of 100 small satellites that collect continuous data on weather systems, air traffic, and shipping movements.

It then sells access to that data through recurring subscriptions.

What does that mean? High margins, predictable renewals, and minimal dependence on any single government contract.

However, 2025 was difficult for Spire.



SEP
2025

OCT

NOV

DEC

JAN
2026

FEB



Briefs Terminal

Data via Briefs Terminal

The company exited its maritime data business - a segment generating over \$40 million annually - and the process was messy, involving a failed sale, legal complications, and a compliance notice from the NYSE.

So far, though, the exit appears to be the right call strategically.

Without maritime dragging it down, Spire enters 2026 with:

- No debt on its balance sheet.
- A backlog of future business exceeding \$200 million against a market cap of roughly \$278 million.
- And management is guiding for 30% revenue growth in the year ahead.

Business Update

Several significant awards drove remaining performance obligation expansion; currently over \$200 million as of September 30, 2025

**Deloitte
Selects Spire
to Deliver
Advanced
Satellite
Capabilities,
Expanding
Their
On-Orbit
Cyber and
Data
Operations**

8 satellites

**Spire Global
Awarded
\$11.2 Million
NOAA
Contract for
Satellite
Weather
Data**

**Radio
Occultation
data**

**Spire Global
Awarded
\$2.5 Million
NOAA
Contract for
Satellite
Weather
Data**

**Ocean
Winds
Data**

**EUMETSAT
Awards Spire
Global \$3
Million
Contract
Renewal for
satellite
Weather
Data**

**Radio
Occultation
Data**

SPACE INFRASTRUCTURE BEING REPLENISHED AND EXPANDED

- 12 satellites launched in November
- 9 satellites shipped to launch site for early 2026 launch, including Spire's next-generation Hyperspectral Microwave Sounder - a compact, space-ready sensor build to demonstrate global weather forecasting from space
- On-orbit data production is expected to increase 10-fold for RF-GL products and 3-fold in our daily RO profiles



Data [via](#) Spire Global's investor presentation

Its recovery is still in the early stages, but shares are up 12% since January.

We believe Spire is not finished - and its comeback is just getting started.

Its foundation is now solid in a way it wasn't a year ago, which is why investors will want to keep an eye on Spire this year.

RISKS

How This Shift Could Change

Most space-related risks are company-specific - burning too much cash, missed launches, and contract delays.

But there's one macro risk in 2026 that could affect the entire sector simultaneously: SpaceX.

SpaceX is widely expected to pursue a [public offering](#) in the next 12 months.

- Estimates anticipate its valuation could be in the range of \$1.5 trillion following its merger with xAI.

If that offering happens, it will almost certainly trigger a rotation - investors selling positions in smaller space companies to fund allocation into the category leader.

Quality companies could see their share prices fall, not because anything went wrong with their business, but simply because a larger opportunity entered the room.

SpaceX is the undisputed leader of rocket launches and satellites in space - it also has extensive missions to Mars planned alongside NASA.

If a selloff happens, it could create better buying opportunities in other space stocks like Rocket Lab, Planet Labs, and Spire.

But no one knows if SpaceX will swallow up the entire industry or join the ranks among the other established space names.

Either way, investors will want to consider both business and macro risks to this shift that could impact prices negatively in 2026 and beyond.

REVIEW

The Next Investing Frontier

Our take on space has become more firm over the last year and revolves around a simple question:

Which companies moved from promising to performing?

That question eliminated a lot of names that were easy to get excited about eighteen months ago.

It also clarified which ones we're betting on and holding.

Still, the sector still carries real risk - the path to profitability is long for most of these businesses, and a SpaceX IPO could change everything.

But the overall market shift remains the same.

Infrastructure needs to be built, governments are spending, contracts are growing, and the companies that survive in the short-term may be worth looking at in the long-term for investors.



- Market Briefs Pro Team

*The Market Briefs Pro team often invests in the same stocks and assets we cover.

Why? Because we believe in practicing what we preach (and preaching what we practice).

But keep in mind: We're not financial advisors. Everything we provide is for education. You've got to do your own due diligence and think about what makes sense for your own financial situation. Investing has risks.

You are never guaranteed to make money when you invest, you might even lose money. If you're looking for personalized financial advice, we highly recommend speaking with a licensed financial advisor.

Our mission? It's simple - to help you be better with money.

Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.